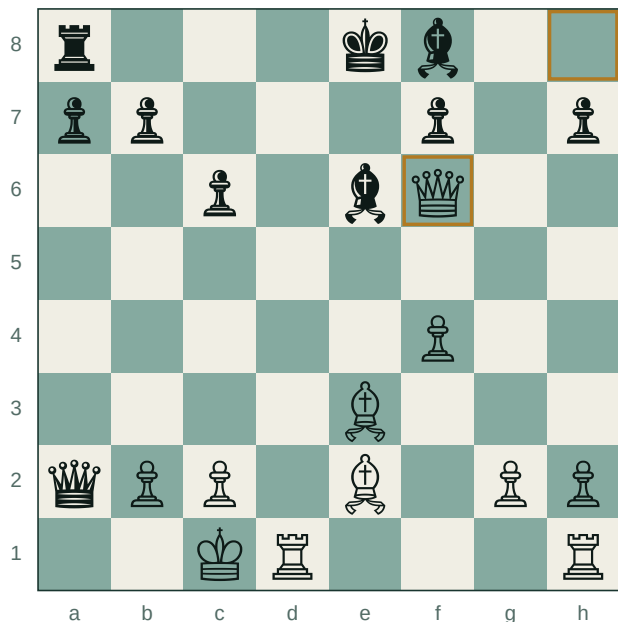


Interference tactics: Black, move 15

Interference tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 15.Qf6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

15...Qa1+ 16. Kd2 Bb4+ 17. c3 Qxb2+ 18. Ke1 Bxc3+ 19. Qxc3 Qxc3+

15...Qa1+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **16.Kd2**.

16...Bb4+ Check restricts White to 3 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **17.c3**.

17...Qxb2+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. The move also takes the pawn on b2. Recorded reply: **18.Ke1**.

18...Bxc3+ Check restricts White to 5 legal replies here. From c3 it attacks king on e1 and queen on f6. Recorded reply: **19.Qxc3**.

19...Qxc3+ Check restricts White to 4 legal replies here. From c3 it attacks king on e1 and bishop on e3.

At the end, nominal material is White 19 / Black 22 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +8. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +8**: the balance goes from -5 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Capturing the interposing piece may restore defense. Calculate which captures are legal and whether they permit another tactic.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Interference interrupts a defensive line between enemy pieces. Occupying one square can make a previously protected target vulnerable or prevent an important recapture.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the defender's line to its target and inspect forcing moves onto the intervening squares.

The defending king is on c1. Geometrically undefended: queen on f6 and bishop on e3. Check for tactical protection.